

Not Quite “Shorthorn”

We’ve been following its progress since the Longhorn-code-name days, and there were news reports that went about calling it “Shorthorn,” mostly because WinFS was dropped from what is now Vista. However, even without WinFS—and without some of the other trappings that Longhorn was supposed to ship with—you’ll find, when you use it, that Windows Vista is quite the wonderful new operating system it was supposed to be.

This book doesn’t assume, one way or the other, that you have Vista installed. If you do, this is a quick-start guide; if you don’t, this is a sneak-peek. Read it and decide whether it’s what you wanted it to be.

For those curious about how it all came to be, we have, in Chapter 2, how Vista evolved; for those just curious, we have Chapters 3 and 4, where we go into what’s new and what’s inside the new OS. Then on, we get to describing how things work in Vista, with, naturally, an emphasis on how the working departs from XP (which, we’re assuming, most of you are currently using).

Search—whether on the Internet or on our own systems—can only take on greater importance with time, and Vista has a radically new approach to Search, which is why we’ve devoted an entire chapter to it.

The security of Vista as an OS has been (as you’d expect it to be) much-discussed, and we discuss the final implementation of Vista’s security measures in Chapter 6.

DirectX 10 is here, and that’s what many of you are probably most excited about: we talk of Vista’s gaming possibilities in the last chapter, on Gaming. The other chapters are a walkthrough to most of the other functions in the new OS, but always with an emphasis on how things have evolved since XP.

It was hyped, then de-hyped, then hyped again—and now it’s here. Whether or not you’ll use it, read what follows to get a flavour for the best operating system from Microsoft ever—and we’re happy this *Fast Track* coincides with our Anniversary Issue!